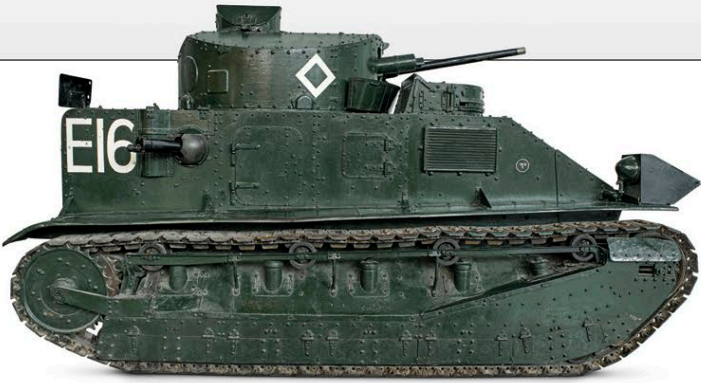


Medium and Heavy Tanks

Slower and more powerful vehicles, the medium and heavy tanks were intended to take on enemy armor and fortifications, creating the breakthrough for faster vehicles to exploit. In general, armor protection and firepower were therefore emphasized over mobility. The Vickers Independent's multiple turrets influenced a number of these tanks, and Walter Christie's suspension system also began to find favor. Many nations purchased the Vickers Mark E, with some, like the Soviet Union, using it as a starting point to develop their own designs.

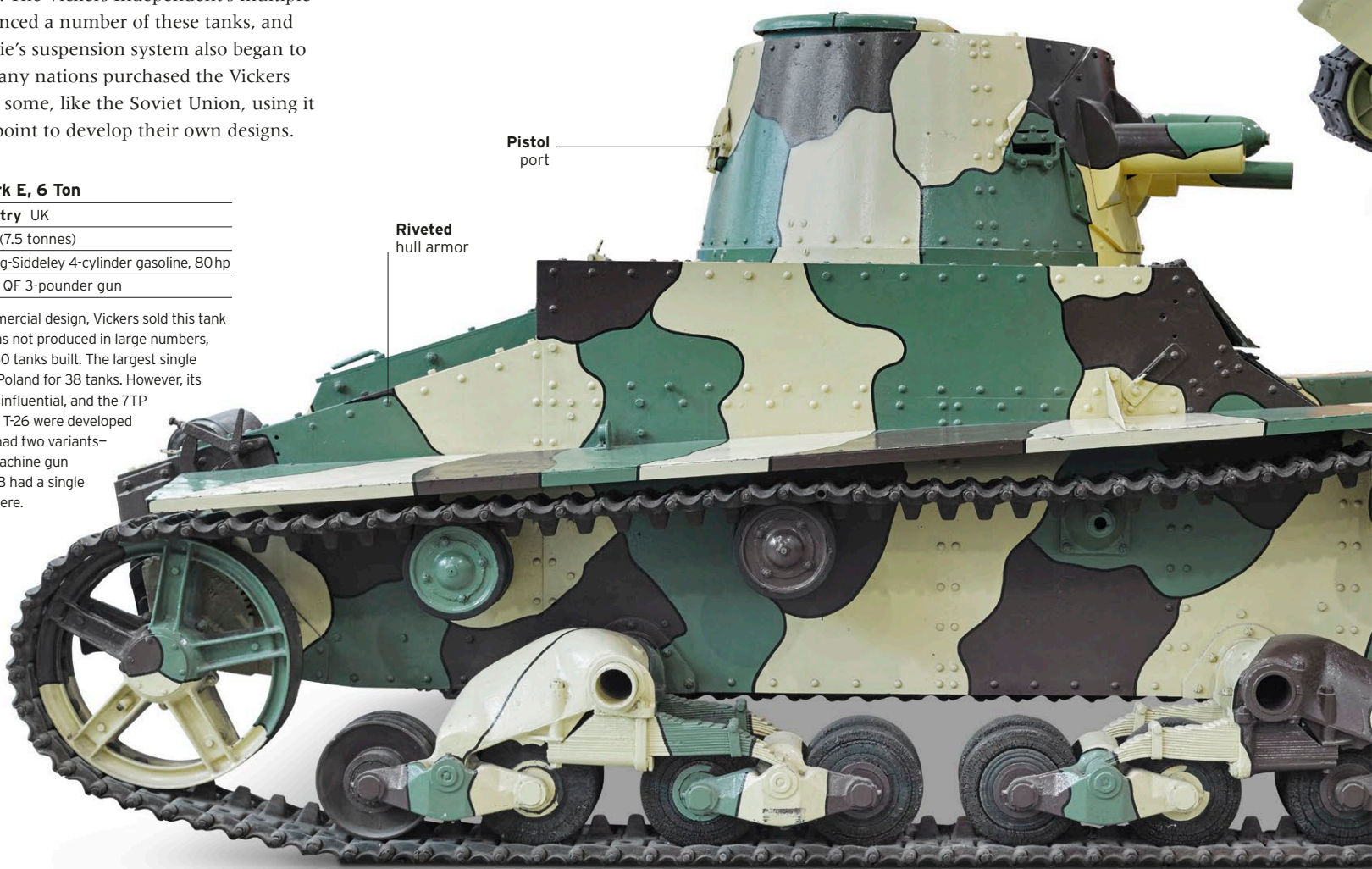
▷ Vickers Mark E, 6 Ton
Date 1928 Country UK
Weight 8.3 tons (7.5 tonnes)
Engine Armstrong-Siddeley 4-cylinder gasoline, 80hp
Main armament QF 3-pounder gun

A successful commercial design, Vickers sold this tank to 12 nations. It was not produced in large numbers, with only about 150 tanks built. The largest single order came from Poland for 38 tanks. However, its design was highly influential, and the 7TP (see pp.70-71) and T-26 were developed from it. The tank had two variants—Type A had two machine gun turrets, and Type B had a single turret, as shown here.



◁ Vickers Medium Mark II*
Date 1926 Country UK
Weight 15.1 tons (13.7 tonnes)
Engine Armstrong-Siddeley V8 gasoline, 90hp
Main armament QF 3-pounder gun

The very similar Medium Mark Is and IIs served the Royal Tank Corps from 1923 to 1938. They were the first turreted tanks in British service, and although they saw no action, they had an enormous influence on the design work done between the wars. A total of 166 tanks were built.



△ T-26
Date 1931 Country Soviet Union
Weight 10.4 tons (9.4 tonnes)
Engine T-26 4-cylinder gasoline, 91hp
Main armament 45 mm 20K Model 1934 L/46 gun

The T-26 was by far the most widely produced tank of this period. A total of 12,000 tanks, including 2,000 twin-turreted vehicles and 1,700 variants, were built. It was used in the Spanish Civil War, but its weaknesses were soon exposed, and despite upgrades it was outclassed by 1939. In the Far East, some survived until 1945.

▽ T-28
Date 1933 Country Soviet Union
Weight 31.9 tons (29 tonnes)
Engine Mikulin M17T gasoline, 500hp
Main armament 76.2 mm KT-28 L26 howitzer

A multiturreted design, the T-28 was intended for infantry support, so it was armed with a howitzer rather than an antitank gun. Around 500 were built. Experience in Poland and Finland led to extra armor being applied to some vehicles.

